Mahatma Gandhi University, Kottayam-
Third Semester MGU-UGP – BSW (Honours) Regular Examination October 2025
Discipline specific core course(DSC)-MG3DSCSWK202-Social Analysis And Strategies For Social Change - QP Code: 25900633

Part A Short Answer Questions- Answer 5 questions / each question carries 2 marks

1.	Define Gandhian non violence in social change a. Gandhian non-violence (Ahimsa) emphasizes peaceful means to achieve justice and harmony without causing harm to others. b. It promotes truth, love, and moral courage as tools for transforming society and resolving conflict	[U]/[CO1] 2 marks
2.	Mention one step involved in social analysis of real-world issues. **Identifying the root causes** of a problem to understand structural and systemic factors influencing the issue.	[K]/[CO1] 2 marks
3.	Explain the term Dalit. a. "Dalit" refers to socially oppressed groups traditionally placed outside the Hindu caste system. b. The term signifies resilience and the struggle for equality, dignity, and social justice.	[U]/[CO2 2 marks]
4.	Define the term religious minority. a. Religious minorities are groups whose faith differs from that of the majority population in a country. b. They are recognized and protected to ensure freedom of religion and equal rights under the law.	[K]/[CO3] 2 marks
5.	Define community organizing a. Community organizing is a process of bringing people together to identify common problems and take collective action. b. It aims to empower communities to influence decision-making and promote social change.	[K]/[CO4] 2 marks
6.	Explain why evaluation is important in social interventions. a. Evaluation helps measure the effectiveness and outcomes of programs or activities. b. It provides feedback for improving future planning and accountability.	[U]/[CO5] 2 marks
7.	List two elements of social identity **Gender** and **ethnicity** are key elements shaping an individual's social identity.	[K]/[CO6] 2 marks

Part B Short Eaaay- Answer 4 questions / each question carries 5 marks

8.	Explain the concept of intersectionality with an example. a. Intersectionality refers to how different aspects of a person's identity—such as gender, caste, class, race, and sexuality—interact to shape their experiences of privilege or oppression. b. It recognizes that people face multiple, overlapping forms of discrimination in society. c. This concept helps in understanding social inequality more deeply rather than viewing each identity in isolation. d. Policies and social actions using intersectionality aim to address these combined disadvantages. e. **Example:** A Dalit woman may face both caste-based and gender-based discrimination, unlike an upper-caste woman or a Dalit man	[U]/[CO1] 5 marks
9.	Describe how capacity-building strengthens social change initiatives a. Capacity-building enhances individuals' and communities' skills, knowledge, and resources for action. b. It empowers people to take ownership of social change rather than depend on external actors. c. Training and education improve leadership, organization, and problem-solving abilities. d. It ensures sustainability of programs by developing local expertise. e. Strong capacity-building leads to greater participation and long-term social	[U]/[CO5] 5 marks

	transformation.	
10.	Describe the role of NGOs in policy advocacy. a. NGOs represent marginalized voices and influence public policy for social justice. b. They conduct research, raise awareness, and provide data to support policy reforms. c. NGOs engage with government bodies, media, and communities to lobby for inclusive laws. d. They monitor implementation of policies and hold authorities accountable. e. Examples include campaigns for women's rights, environmental protection, and child welfare.	[U]/[CO4 5 marks]
11.	Examine the role of media in reinforcing or challenging gender stereotypes. a. Media often reinforces gender stereotypes by portraying men as powerful and women as submissive. b. It shapes public attitudes toward gender roles through advertisements, films, and news. c. However, progressive media can challenge stereotypes by highlighting equality and diverse gender identities. d. Social media platforms provide space for feminist and LGBTQ+ movements to voice concerns. e. Balanced representation in media promotes gender sensitivity and social awareness.	[An]/ [CO2] 5 marks
12.	Describe ways to promote accountability and transparency in social change a. Establish clear goals, roles, and responsibilities for all stakeholders. b. Regular monitoring, evaluation, and reporting ensure progress tracking. c. Encourage community participation and feedback mechanisms. d. Use technology (like open data platforms) to share information publicly. e. Promote ethical standards and independent audits to prevent misuse of resources.	[U]/[CO6] 5 marks
13.	Explain the concept of digital activism with examples. a. Digital activism uses online platforms to promote social and political causes. b. It enables mass participation through social media, websites, and digital campaigns. c. Hashtags and viral content can rapidly raise awareness and mobilize support. d. It allows marginalized voices to reach global audiences at low cost. e. **Examples:** #MeToo movement against sexual harassment, and #BlackLivesMatter for racial justice.	[U]/[CO5] 5 marks
14.	Compare and contrast the development of a planned city versus an unplanned city. a. **Planned cities** are developed systematically with zoning, infrastructure, and services designed in advance (e.g., Chandigarh). b. **Unplanned cities** grow spontaneously without proper layout or urban planning (e.g., many old city areas). c. Planned cities offer better sanitation, transport, and green spaces. d. Unplanned cities often face overcrowding, pollution, and inadequate public services. e. Proper urban planning in cities promotes sustainability, efficiency, and a better quality of life.	[An]/ [CO3] 5 marks

Part C Essay- Answer 2 questions / each question carries 10 marks

15.	Analyse the role of communication skills in the success of social action campaigns. a. Effective communication creates awareness and mobilizes people toward a shared social cause. b. Clear messaging helps convey complex social issues in simple and relatable ways. c. Persuasive communication influences public opinion and encourages collective participation. d. Active listening allows campaigners to understand community needs and feedback. e. Non-verbal skills such as body language and visuals strengthen emotional appeal. f. Use of mass media and social media platforms widens the campaign's reach and visibility. g. Transparent communication builds trust between activists, communities, and	[An]/ [CO5] 10 marks

	stakeholders. h. Strategic storytelling helps humanize issues and connect emotionally with audiences. i. Multilingual and culturally sensitive communication ensures inclusion of diverse groups. j. Overall, strong communication fosters unity, motivation, and sustained engagement in social action	
16.	Critique the effectiveness of existing environmental laws in protecting vulnerable communities in India. a. India has major environmental laws like the **Environment Protection Act (1986)**, **Air Act (1981)**, and **Water Act (1974)**. b. While these laws aim to prevent pollution and ensure ecological balance, their implementation remains weak. c. Industrial and developmental projects often ignore the consent and rights of local and tribal populations. d. Lack of proper monitoring and corruption undermine enforcement of environmental regulations. e. Judicial interventions (like NGT rulings) help but are limited by slow processes and poor compliance. f. Environmental Impact Assessments (EIA) are often manipulated to favor corporate interests. g. Vulnerable communities suffer disproportionately from pollution, displacement, and resource loss. h. Policies rarely integrate **climate justice** or protection for marginalized livelihoods (farmers, fishers, Adivasis). i. Strengthening local governance, transparency, and public participation is essential. j. Hence, while laws exist, their **ineffective implementation** fails to adequately protect vulnerable groups.	[E]/[CO3 10 marks]
17.	Discuss the role of social movements in addressing social problems with examples. a. Social movements are collective efforts by people to demand justice, equality, and policy change. b. They challenge social norms, institutions, and power structures that perpetuate inequality. c. Movements like the **Dalit Movement** fought caste discrimination and untouchability. d. The **Women's Movement** in India addressed issues of gender bias, violence, and equal rights. e. **Environmental movements** such as the **Chipko Movement** and **Narmada Bachao Andolan** protested ecological exploitation. f. The **LGBTQ+ rights movement** pushed for decriminalizing homosexuality (Sec. 377 judgment). g. Youth and student movements have influenced education reforms and democratic participation. h. Social movements provide platforms for marginalized voices and grassroots leadership. i. They also influence public opinion, media discourse, and legislative reforms. j. Thus, social movements act as vital instruments of democratic participation and social transformation.	[An]/ [CO4] 10 marks
18.	Discuss the application of conflict theory in addressing caste, class, or gender inequality a. Conflict theory, proposed by Karl Marx, views society as divided by power and resource inequalities. b. It argues that social change occurs through struggles between dominant and oppressed groups. c. In **caste inequality**, conflict theory explains how upper castes maintain dominance through control over land and culture. d. Dalit movements and affirmative action challenge this structural oppression. e. In **class inequality**, it highlights the exploitation of workers by capitalist elites who control production. f. Trade unions and socialist movements embody resistance to class-based exploitation.	[An]/ [CO1] 10 marks

	g. In **gender inequality**, the theory shows how patriarchy sustains male dominance in social, economic, and political spheres. h. Feminist movements act as agents of conflict-driven social change challenging patriarchal norms. i. Conflict theory promotes redistribution of power and equality through reform or revolution. j. Hence, it provides a critical lens to understand and address systemic inequalities in caste, class, and gender..	